and finance. This economic division resulted in political instability, not just in poor nations but across the world. According to Brandt “At the beginning of a new decade, only twenty years short of the millennium, we must try to lift ourselves above the day-to-day quarrels (or negotiations) to see the menacing long-term problems. We see a world in which poverty and hunger still prevail in many huge regions; in which resources are squandered without consideration of their renewal; in which more armaments are made and sold than ever before; and where a destructive capacity has been accumulated to blow up our planet several times over” (*North–South*). In *North–South* (1980) and *Common Crisis* (1983), the Brandt Commission made a set of bold recommendations to change the present unequal international economic order. The Brandt Reports called for a full-scale restructuring of the global economy, along with a new approach to the problems of development, including an emergency programme to end poverty in the developing nations.

On the recommendations of Brandt Commission, a Summit Conference was held in Cancun, Mexico on 22–23 October 1981. The Cancun Summit focused on the issue of structuring of global negotiations. The United States however, had its own reservations and it did not want to compromise the supremacy of IMF and the World Bank to United Nations in global negotiations, for in these specialized agencies, the developed countries were the major decision makers than in the UN General Assembly. Though the spirit of Cancun was thought to be providing a boost to NIEO but actually by 1984, the North–South dialogue could not make headway and it stood frozen.

The international community had not responded to NIEO proposals in any meaningful way and though the Brandt Reports though were widely read and discussed, developed nations had focused more on their own interests solely and have not contributed to the realization of NIEO. As documented by the United Nations Development Programme, the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund, and other agencies, the economic disparities outlined in the Brandt Reports had widened significantly since 1980s.

Failure to address the need for NIEO is a lost opportunity for